

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | 3rd Line Security Operations, Stakeholder Engagement and Strategic Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in both hands-on 3rd line security operations and strategic security advisory. I combine deep technical expertise in threat detection, incident response and vulnerability management with a proven ability to communicate clearly and confidently with senior non-technical stakeholders. In my current role at the University of the Arts, London, I operate as the technical hub for a security function supporting over 8,000 users across multiple sites, regularly facing off to senior leadership, colleagues across global offices and external auditors. I bring the technical depth and the professional credibility to add value from day one in a demanding professional services environment where both technical precision and stakeholder management matter.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Operations (3rd Line):** Threat hunting, advanced alert triage, forensic investigation, root cause analysis and post-incident reporting; Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform ownership
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR - Expert; Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) - Strong; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) - Strong
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle incident management aligned to National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK; stakeholder communication and executive reporting during and after major incidents
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-prioritised remediation and executive-level reporting
- **Stakeholder Engagement and Communication:** Proven ability to present complex security risk to senior non-technical stakeholders; experience producing risk assessments, security roadmaps and governance reporting for leadership and audit audiences
- **Security Frameworks and Governance:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Additional Tools:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Mimecast, BeyondTrust, Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Act as the primary technical security lead and escalation point for a security function covering 8,000 users across multiple campuses, combining 3rd line hands-on investigation with strategic security planning and governance delivery
- Face off regularly to senior leadership, Heads of Department and colleagues across global offices to communicate security risk, incident status and remediation progress in clear, non-technical language
- Lead all significant security incidents end-to-end from initial detection and triage through forensic investigation, containment, eradication and post-incident review, producing executive-level incident reports
- Own the Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender for

Endpoint (MDE), tuning detection rules and developing SOAR automation playbooks to improve operational effectiveness

- Conduct proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, identifying emerging threats before they escalate to incidents
- Manage and report on the vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io and AppCheck, translating technical risk into clear business impact assessments for senior stakeholders
- Maintain BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and identity controls in Microsoft Entra ID including Conditional Access, MFA and Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- Produce ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus governance artefacts, risk registers, security roadmaps and reports for audit and leadership audiences
- Provide security guidance to technology and transformation projects, advising on risks and security requirements from initiation through delivery

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Carried out day-to-day security monitoring, alert triage and incident response across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, developing detection rules and tuning platforms to reduce alert fatigue and improve signal quality
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies and MFA for identity governance across on-premises and cloud environments
- Implemented Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the organisation, improving coverage and threat detection for endpoint and identity-based attack vectors
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, managing remediation tracking and producing regular reports for the security leadership team
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate alert triage, reporting and user provisioning workflows, reducing manual effort and improving consistency
- Supported penetration testing exercises, co-ordinating technical remediation and providing updates to stakeholders on risk reduction progress
- Produced governance documentation, security policies and awareness materials for both technical and non-technical audiences

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security and infrastructure support for a SaaS/FinTech platform, managing endpoint security, access provisioning and vulnerability management
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence gathering, risk register maintenance and audit preparation, interacting with internal and external auditors
- Managed user access reviews and least-privilege enforcement across cloud and on-premises systems
- Provided 2nd and 3rd line security incident support, collaborating across development and infrastructure teams to resolve issues effectively

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end incident response for multiple high-severity security incidents, producing executive-level post-incident reports and presenting findings and recommendations to senior leadership across global offices
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate, designing prevention policies, detection rules and SOAR-driven response workflows that materially improved mean time to detect and respond
- Successfully achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, leading all technical preparation, scoping and assessor engagement from initial gap assessment to certification
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating standing privileged access across all administrator accounts and reducing privileged credential risk
- Reduced vulnerability remediation backlog by 60% through a structured, risk-prioritised remediation programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io

- Developed a suite of PowerShell automation tools that reduced manual security operations workload by an estimated 10+ hours per week, allowing the team to focus on higher-value investigation and strategic activities

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)